

A Star Fleet Battles™ Scenario

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(SH _____.0) REVENGE OF CRIMINALS

This scenario recounts the incredible seizure of a Federation NCL and its use in a devastating surprise attack against a Federation heavy cruiser. NCL *Valiant* mistakenly visited a forgotten penal colony, which was inhabited by genetically-engineered super-criminals (who had both intelligence and physical strength substantially above human norms). The ship was commandeered by a small group of criminals after they took the captain hostage when he foolishly beamed down to the planet's surface.

Following the take-over, the criminal mastermind leading the escaped prisoners marooned nearly all of the NCL's crew on the penal colony, then set off in pursuit of the Star Fleet officers responsible for the original imprisonment of the fugitives. They caught up to them, aboard a Federation CA on a training mission, after the criminals had plundered a nearby small research outpost adjacent to a nebula.

The NCL launched a surprise attack on the CA, crippling it. But the heavy cruiser's resourceful crew was able to use their superior knowledge of Federation ship systems and security measures to make their own surprise counter-attack, inflicting serious damage to *Valiant* and allowing the heavy cruiser a chance to escape.

(SH _____.1) NUMBER OF PLAYERS: 2, Starfleet player and escaped criminals player

(SH _____.2) INITIAL SETUP:

TERRAIN: An uninhabited 1-hex airless planetoid is located on map #1, in hex 2215, with a GSO (unmanned, WS-0) on the A facing; hex row XX28 of map #2, and all of map #3, is a "quiet" nebula.

STARFLEET: Federation CAR+ on map #2 in Hex 1015, heading B, speed 0, WS-I.

ESCAPED CRIMINALS: Federation NCL+ on map #2, Hex 1015, heading E, speed 1, WS-I.

YEAR: This is set in Y187, but players may choose a different year, which may affect available ships, weapons, and refits.

(SH _____.3) LENGTH OF SCENARIO: Scenario continues until all forces from one side have been destroyed, captured, or have disengaged.

(SH _____.4) SPECIAL RULES

(SH _____.41) MAP: Until (SH _____.4713) applies, the map is fixed (does not float). The scenario uses three standard maps, with hex rows XX30 of map #1 adjacent to hex row XX01 of map #2, and hex rows XX30 of map #2 adjacent to hex rows XX01 of map #3.

(SH _____.411): Only the NCL may transition from tactical warp and it is the only unit (SH _____.4613) which may disengage by acceleration.

(SH _____.412): If the CA leaves the map prior to the destruction (by whatever means) of the NCL, or prior to the activation the stolen weapon system (SH _____.47), the Starfleet player loses and the CA is considered destroyed.

(SH _____.413): If the NCL leaves the map prior to the destruction of the CA, and the CA still has at least 15 operational Warp Engine boxes; or, the NCL forces the CA to leave the map *via* a tractor beam (this applies even if the tractor-link is broken before the CA leaves the map, but

movement rules subsequently force the CA to leave the map); the escaped criminals player loses and the NCL is considered destroyed. This rule takes precedence over (SH _____.412).

(SH _____.42) SHUTTLES AND PFs:

(SH _____.421): There are no PFs in this scenario.

(SH _____.422): All shuttles have Warp Booster Packs.

(SH _____.43) COMMANDER'S OPTION ITEMS; OPTIONAL RULES:

(SH _____.431): Neither ship may purchase Commander's Option items.

(SH _____.432): Use Critical Hits (D8.0) during this scenario.

(SH _____.44) REFITS: The CA has the Plus, Rear Phaser, Y175 and AWR refits. The NCL has received the Plus, AWR, and Y175 refits.

(SH _____.45) CREW: The NCL is crewed by the unusually tight-knit former inmates of the penal colony, and an unwilling handful of the NCL's officers. The crew of the CA is mostly trainees, as the ship was near to decommissioning and primarily used for training new recruits. However, the heavy cruiser is fully-crewed, and staffed with some cadre, including a Legendary Chief Engineer (G22.4), and a Legendary Weapons Officer (G22.7).

(SH _____.451): Reflecting the fact that most of the recruits haven't completed training (rather than any serious deficiency in their potential), the heavy cruiser functions as if it had a "Poor" crew (G21.1), subject to the following additional adjustments: the probe restriction (G21.115) is ignored; the HET cost (G21.122) and Escape (G21.125) penalties are ignored; if the Legendary Weapons Officer is aboard, alive and located in a control space, then the direct-fire ECM penalty (G21.111) is ignored, but the (G22.71) bonuses are also ignored, as is the (G22.76) repair ability; if the Legendary Chief Engineer is aboard, alive and located in a control space, then the Breakdown (G21.121), Quick Reverse (G21.126) and Repair (G21.132) penalties are ignored, but the (G22.43) bonus is reduced to two points.

(SH _____.452): As the vast majority of the NCL's crew was marooned on the penal colony, and the very few remaining officers operate under extreme duress, the NCL functions as if it had a "Poor" crew (G21.1). Additionally, despite the fact that the commandeering criminals are super-human (in terms of physical and mental capabilities), only so many were on the penal colony; the NCL effectively has six crew units, but no boarding parties or Deck Crews. Even though it has more crew units than required by (G9.41), the escaped criminals lack both training and experience; the ship operates as "undermanned" (G9.42) with a Damage Control Rating of "2"; however, the repair penalty (G21.132) is ignored.

(SH _____.4521): The NCL lacks Deck Crews and qualified pilots, so it may not launch any shuttles, or recover any shuttles launched by the CA (or from the GSO); it could still death-drag a shuttle.

(SH _____.4522): The NCL's (G5.0) self-destruct system is offline and may not be used under any circumstances.

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(SH __.4523): The NCL may not convert crew units into militia (D15.83). However, to reflect both the mania, and the superior personal combat capabilities, of the escaped convicts, the following locations are considered guarded (D7.83) against Hit and Run Raids: Bridge, Auxiliary Control, Impulse, Right Warp, Left Warp. These “guards” do not reduce the number of crew units available for other functions. If the location is destroyed (by any means, including boarding party action), then the “guards” automatically survive as crew units (even if they would ordinarily be killed as a result of boarding party combat), but cannot be used (as guards) elsewhere (but would be usable as guards again if the location was repaired with Damage Control). Convicts functioning only as crew units (including “guards” who survived as crew units) may be killed normally.

(SH __.4524): Because the NCL is so badly undermanned, a Hit and Run Raid (D7.8) against an unguarded system box is resolved as if the attacking boarding party was “Outstanding”, and the (G21.141) penalty is ignored. This reflects the fact that it is impossible for the escaped criminals to effectively defend most of the NCL – they simply do not have enough people, so even an inexperienced boarding party has better chances of both success and survival. Raids against a guarded system box are resolved normally.

(SH __.4525): Note that the NCL will suffer a Turn Mode penalty unless a crew unit is assigned to maneuvering (G9.421). The ship’s ability to fire weapons and/or operate systems (such as tractor beams) is governed by (G9.422).

(SH __.4526): Since relatively few people are on board the NCL, it may use Emergency Life Support (B3.1) during the scenario (most life support functions can be shut down on most decks).

(SH __.46) DAMAGED SYSTEMS: The ships exchanged fire and both sustained damage immediately prior to the start of the scenario.

(SH __.461): Posing as an allied ship, the NCL was able to launch a devastating surprise attack against the CA, which had not raised shields. The NCL scored two Range 0 phaser volleys (for a total of 26 points of damage) through the down #6 shield on the CA, and then scored a third volley with a fully-overloaded photon torpedo through the down #5 shield.

(SH __.4611): Mark the following system boxes as destroyed on the CA: 2xPhaser-3 (360°; mounted on rear hull), 2xPhaser-1 (LF/R), 1xDrone, 2xAWR, 1xBattery, 1xImpulse, 5xLeft Warp, 4xRight Warp, 12xForward Hull, 4xAft Hull, 1xTractor, 1xBridge, 1xTransporter, 1xAuxiliary Control, 2 Crew Units, 2

Boarding Parties.

(SH __.4612): Additionally, mark 2xPhoton as destroyed; however, these two launchers cannot be repaired, by any means (including by the Legendary Chief Engineer), during the scenario.

(SH __.4613): The CA has also suffered a Critical Hit (D8.2) causing its maneuvering to be severely restricted (see die roll 11). While the hit may be repaired (D8.3) normally - note the (G22.42) bonus from the Legendary Chief Engineer - the ship is unable to transition out of tactical warp and therefore cannot disengage by acceleration; technically, it might be able to do so using sub-light evasion, but (SH __.47) makes that more or less moot. To simulate the restriction on the CA, after the Critical Hit is repaired, the CA may use no more than 80% (round down) of its warp engine output for movement (similar to the Critical Hit die roll 12, but this cannot be repaired during the scenario).

(SH __.4614): A power failure has left the CA unable to raise its shields until the start of Turn 3. No special action is required to restore the shields, but there is no way to raise them earlier (nor can the CA use General Shield Reinforcement until then).

(SH __.4615): At the start of Turn 1, the intact batteries of the CA have only one point of power, but can be charged and used normally.

(SH __.4616): The CA uses Emergency Life Support (B3.1) during the scenario.

(SH __.462): Despite effectively crippling the CA, the inexperience of the NCL’s convict crew left their ship vulnerable to a counter-attack. The heavy cruiser’s captain was able to briefly take partial control of the NCL’s computer systems, long enough to lower the NCL’s shields and de-power its weapons. Before the escaped criminals could understand or reverse what was happening, the CA fired two Range 0 phaser volleys (firing two Phaser-1s, plus two Phaser-1s fired as Phaser-3s because of the CA’s power shortage; scoring a total 26 points of damage) through the NCL’s down #1 shield.

(SH __.4621): Mark the following system boxes as destroyed on the NCL: 2xPhaser-3, 1xDrone, 2xAWR, 1xImpulse, 5xLeft Warp, 3xRight Warp, 9xCenter Hull, 1xBridge, 1xAuxiliary Control, 1xSensor.

(SH __.4622): The NCL has also suffered a Critical Hit (D8.2) disabling its Active Fire Control (D6.6). Because the ship is undermanned, and the crew is so inexperienced, no attempt may be made to repair this hit until Turn 3.

(SH __.4623): The subversion of its computer systems (SH __.462) has left the NCL unable to raise its shields, use General Shield Reinforcement, or arm its weapons; it is also unable to operate

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transporters, use EDR, or launch probes. This is “repaired” in the same manner as a Critical Hit (D8.3), but no attempt may be made until Turn 2 (the same “repair” regains control over all affected systems). Note that if the NCL fails to repair this on Turn 2, then the player will have to choose which repair to attempt during Turn 3 (and possibly on subsequent turns) since (D8.31) limits repair attempts to one *per* Turn.

(SH ____4624): Since the NCL is (SH ____442) “undermanned”, each “repair” attempt requires the assignment of a crew unit for the entire Turn.

(SH ____4625): There is no mechanism by which the CA’s crew can repeat the subversion of the NCL’s computer systems; the convict crew is inexperienced, not stupid.

(SH ____47) SPECIAL WEAPON: Before encountering the heavy cruiser, the NCL raided the small science outpost on map #1. While outwardly unremarkable, the science staff of the outpost had made a recent discovery of a new weapons technology, which the criminals naturally stole. The only prototype of the weapon system is aboard the NCL, along with all the computer data that would be needed to replicate the weapon (the staff of the science outpost were killed and its computers wiped).

(SH ____471): Under certain circumstances, the captain (leader of the escapees) of the NCL may activate the weapon system. The captain may do so only if there are boarding parties from the CA that have taken control of an area of the NCL (this does not include Hit and Run Raids (D7.8)); or, the NCL is uncontrolled (G2.2) (because the weapon system is not the ship’s self-destruct system, it may be used even when the ship is uncontrolled); or, the NCL is so badly damaged it cannot fight or disengage (*e.g.*, all photon tubes and phasers are destroyed, and/or all warp engine boxes are destroyed and no more than one impulse box is operational; or, any Excess Damage hits have been scored).

(SH ____4711): When permitted and wanting to utilize the weapon system, the captain of the NCL announces its activation during the Ships Systems Function Stage (6B4) of any impulse. This announcement cannot be rescinded (the prototype has no “off switch”). The system’s unique signature will be immediately detected by the CA.

(SH ____4712): Once activated, the weapon system cannot be transported, de-activated or stopped. In theory, total and complete destruction of the NCL, if accomplished in a single impulse, would also destroy the weapon system, but a boarding party would not be able to do so (any attempt by a boarding party to destroy the activated weapon system would result in its immediate release, as would any attempt to transport it). Any Excess Damage hits during an impulse, if the NCL is not destroyed that impulse, also will release the

activated weapon. The (SH ____4714) delay is ignored in these cases.

(SH ____4713): As soon as the weapon system is activated, the map (SH ____41) is no longer fixed and may float freely.

(SH ____4714): 128 impulses after the weapon system is activated, it is released (after movement, during the Ships Systems Function Stage of the impulse). Its effect will be to utterly destroy any base, ship, shuttlecraft, asteroid or planet within 500,000 hexes. This effect originates at the NCL (destroying it) and moves out spherically at the rate of one hex every other impulse (do not use a speed of 16, as the blast wave may move on Impulse #1). If the CA is caught, it is destroyed.

(SH ____472): Boarding parties cannot find the weapon system before it is activated (and once it is activated, they cannot do anything to stop it). However, if the NCL is destroyed before the weapon is activated, the weapon is not released.

(SH ____48) EXPENDED WEAPONS AND WEAPON STATUS:

(SH ____481): The drone rack aboard the CA was destroyed in the initial attack. As the ship was ostensibly on a training cruise, it has no reloads for the rack or for use as a scatterpack (more accurately, it has no drones with warheads). The CA also has no transporter bombs.

(SH ____482): The CA’s crew made their counter-attack on Impulses #31 and #32 of the Turn prior to Turn 1. No operational phasers are eligible to fire before Impulse #7 of Turn 1; the phaser capacitors were completely drained by the counter-attack and would need to be re-charged. At the start of the scenario, the CA’s player designates which of the surviving phasers fired on which prior impulses.

(SH ____483): The drone rack aboard the NCL was destroyed. The escaped prisoners lack the skills to repair and re-load the rack in anything less than a day. Similarly, as none of them have the skills to function as a Deck Crew, it is not possible for them to use reload drones to launch a scatterpack. The NCL has no transporter bombs (and the crew doesn’t have the skills needed to successfully deploy one in any event).

(SH ____484): Until they regain full control of the NCL’s computer systems (SH ____4623), the NCL’s crew cannot arm any weapons, or transfer power into the phaser capacitor system, or raise or reinforce shields. Once they regain control, the ship will be at WS-I.

(SH ____485): Additionally, until the Critical Hit disabling the NCL’s active fire control (SH ____4622) is repaired, the NCL cannot obtain a weapons lock on the CA, although once the crew has control of their weapons, they can use Passive Fire Control (D19.0) if they don’t repair the Critical Hit first (however, between the penalties from a lack of lock-on and those from the Poor crew, direct-fire from the NCL is likely to be ineffective at anything other than point-blank range).

(SH ____486): The NCL cannot use its probe launcher as a

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weapon (G5.3), even if crippled. The convict crew simply does not have the skills to successfully carry out the procedures. If they attempt to do so, then on the eighth impulse of arming (G5.32) the NCL is immediately destroyed by an internal anti-matter explosion that causes an engine core breach (which may damage nearby units, as if the NCL had self-destructed). The breach also destroys the stolen weapon system (SH _____.47) without releasing it (even if activated).

(SH _____.49) DISENGAGEMENT:

(SH _____.491): The warp drive of the CA is damaged in such a way that even once the Critical Hit (SH _____.4613) is repaired, the ship can only use tactical warp, and so effectively cannot disengage by acceleration. If the CA attempts to disengage using sub-light evasion, then it is considered destroyed. The warp drive can be repaired to operate normally, but will require several days to do so.

(SH _____.492): The mania of the escaped convicts aboard the NCL means that they will not disengage unless the CA is so badly crippled it cannot get away before the NCL can return to finish it off (SH _____.413).

(SH _____.493): If the stolen weapon system (SH _____.47) has detonated (SH _____.4714), then on any impulse where the CA is: 1. is moving directly away from the approaching blast wave; and, 2. is more than two hexes from the wave; and, 3. has attained (and can sustain) a speed of at least 16; then the CA successfully outruns the blast wave and survives. This requires (under (SH _____.4613)) that the heavy cruiser generates at least 20 points of power from its warp engine boxes, or 19 points from its warp engine boxes and one from impulse power.

(SH _____.5) **VICTORY CONDITIONS:** If the NCL is destroyed and the CA survives, the Star Fleet player wins. If the CA is destroyed or captured, then the escaped prisoners win, even if the NCL is destroyed. However, if the CA is destroyed but the NCL is, somehow, captured, it is a Draw.

(SH _____.6) VARIATIONS:

(SH _____.61) Start the scenario with the ships adjacent to (or close by) the planetoid (on opposite sides); the NCL is in Standard Orbit (P8.0) and cannot break orbit until it has a line-of-sight on the CA. The Star Fleet player chooses the initial locations of both ships, the direction of orbit for the NCL, and the facing and speed of the CA (and the NCL must declare its speed prior to Energy Allocation). All critical hits described above have been repaired, but the CA is still unable to use more than 80% of its warp engine output for movement.

(SH _____.62) Require the CA to approach the planetoid - or use (SH _____.61) for starting positions - to recover a landing party that had been sent to search the GSO (recovered as a single crew unit); until it does so, the CA doesn't have a Legendary Weapons Officer. The NCL cannot attack the landing party (it doesn't have any boarding parties to send). If the landing party is not recovered, then if the stolen weapon system is released and destroys the planetoid but the CA survives, the result of this variation is a Draw.

(SH _____.63) Allow the NCL to activate the (SH _____.47) stolen weapon system at any time after Turn 9, not just when boarded or too badly

damaged to fight or run.

(SH _____.7) **BALANCE:** The scenario can be balanced between players of different skill levels by one or more of the following:

(SH _____.71) The scenario can be made more-difficult for the Star Fleet player by any of the following:

(SH _____.711): Allow the NCL to attempt to repair one of the Critical Hits (SH _____.4622) (SH _____.4623) starting on Turn 1 or Turn 2.

(SH _____.712): Allow the NCL to automatically regain control of its weapons and shields (SH _____.4623), instead of having to roll, and possibly to do so on Turn 2 (or earlier).

(SH _____.713): Allow the NCL to raise minimal shields (D3.33) on Turn 2 (SH _____.4623).

(SH _____.714): Allow the NCL to have more Crew Units than noted in (SH _____.452), although not more than nine.

(SH _____.715): Substitute an NCA for the NCL and make the following changes to the (SH _____.4621) damage allocation: the Center Hull hits become Forward Hull hits, the Sensor hit becomes an Aft Hull hit, the Auxiliary Control hit becomes a Drone hit, the APR hits become AWR hits, the Impulse hit becomes an Aft Hull hit. Alternatively, reallocate the same number of hits using the DAC.

(SH _____.72) The scenario can be made more-difficult for the Escaped Criminal player by any of the following:

(SH _____.721): Allow the CA to raise its shields (SH _____.4614) on Turn 2, or even sometime during Turn 1.

(SH _____.722): Score the damage to one or both of the CA's Phaser-1s (SH _____.4611) as Shuttle Bay hits.

(SH _____.723): Give the CA a Legendary Navigator (G22.8).

(SH _____.724): Substitute a CC+ for the CA and score a Phaser-1 hit as a Flag Bridge hit.

(SH _____.725): Allow the CA to have more power in its undamaged batteries, and/or score the battery hit as either a tractor beam or a transporter hit.

(SH _____.8) TACTICS:

Star Fleet Player: Make for the nebula. Yes, your shields will be almost useless and the EW environment horrific, but the NCL will be affected just as badly (worse, since the NCL's crew doesn't include a Legendary Weapons Officer). Outside of the nebula, do not close with the NCL, and don't let them tractor you before you can get into the nebula (remember that the nebula will break a tractor beam if you enter it while tractored). You must repair as much of your warp drive as possible, as you cannot afford to lose more than a few warp engine boxes. If the NCL gets close and takes down a shield before you reach the nebula, Hit-and-Run Raids may be your only hope!

Escaped Prisoners Player: The CA is going to be able to fire, and probably raise shields, before you can, so initially you must get clear and stay out of the CA's arcs (remember, the side phasers can fire directly behind the ship). However, do not let them enter the nebula! Once they go in, you lose every advantage you have. It is crucial that you regain fire control, then obliterate the CA. There's not much you can do about your opponent's boarding parties, so don't waste any time before you start

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pounding on them (remember that you can win even if you are destroyed). If you can damage more than about five warp engine boxes, it will be all but impossible for the heavy cruiser to escape the stolen weapon system.

Historical Outcome: The CA managed to draw *Valiant* into the nebula, where the odds were even. Using the inexperience of the criminals against them, the heavy cruiser eventually maneuvered into an advantageous position and savagely crippled the NCL with combined photon and phaser fire, destroying the warp drive and rendering the hijacked ship uncontrolled. Their goose cooked, the last of the escaped criminals made one final stab and activated the stolen weapon system; the CA narrowly outran the resulting blast.

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